

Post-incident review PIR-2025-004

Customer Portal: degraded latency

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 09 May 2025, Customer Portal experienced degraded latency in staging (AU Southeast) for about 75 minutes. A partner raised a case with the service desk before any internal signal fired. Investigation found that one tenant's bulk import consumed most of the shared queue throughput.

Impact

Users of Customer Portal saw degraded latency for about 75 minutes. The service owner, Digital Channels, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:12 First signal received.
- 09:29 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:45 Likely cause identified.
- 10:27 Mitigation applied.
- 10:31 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that one tenant's bulk import consumed most of the shared queue throughput.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Add a synthetic probe that exercises the affected path every minute.
- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.